

KIAN WOODS

EXPERIENCED SOFTWARE ENGINEER

CONTACT

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Pittsburgh, PA 
[LinkedIn](#) 

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science
Computer Science
Carnegie Mellon University
2016 - 2020
Pittsburgh, PA

SKILLS

Technical Documentation

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Software Development
Associate (IEEE)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer

Duolingo

August 2023 - current / Pittsburgh, PA

- Developed backend services supporting lesson delivery and progress tracking features, enabling the platform to process ~16k user learning events daily across multiple language courses.
- Optimized content retrieval logic in Python, **lowering average lesson loading latency by 32%** for mobile and web learners.
- Implemented automated validation checks for learning progress data across 6 platform services, improving accuracy of user progress tracking.
- Collaborated with product managers and data teams to deliver feature updates on a two-week release cadence, accelerating rollout of learning experience improvements.

DevOps Engineer

PNC Financial Services

June 2020 - June 2023 / Pittsburgh, PA

- Built automated infrastructure deployment pipelines supporting enterprise banking services, enabling provisioning across 14 application environments.
- Reduced average system deployment time by 26 minutes per release by refining CI/CD workflows and build automation processes.
- Integrated monitoring and alerting systems using AWS, improving early detection of infrastructure anomalies across 4 production clusters.
- Partnered with development and operations teams to implement reliability improvements that **raised internal platform stability scores to 4.6 / 5**.

Software Developer Intern

Vanguard

2019 - 2020 / Remote

- Developed internal dashboards for tracking portfolio analytics, enabling analysts to monitor 120+ investment performance metrics in a centralized interface.
- Automated recurring financial data preparation scripts in Python, **reducing manual reporting effort by ~5 hours weekly** for the analytics team.
- Investigated inconsistencies in market data ingestion pipelines, resolving issues affecting three external financial data feeds.
- Documented API usage and data pipeline workflows using Python and AWS, reducing onboarding time for new interns by 20 hours.